

From Test to Territory: How a 4.09× ROAS Launch Uncovered a 58.28× Opportunity

A test campaign in New Zealand turned a profit. But the data pointed to a bigger opportunity next door. Moving the budget to Australia turned a solid 4.09× return into 58.28×.



Executive Summary

The client initially aimed to expand into the New Zealand market through Meta Ads. After launching the campaign and evaluating its performance, I identified that the market was not delivering the expected profitability or scalability. Rather than increasing ad spend, I conducted a strategic audit of the client's historical advertising data across multiple markets and found that Australia offered significantly stronger growth potential. Based on these insights, I recommended shifting the expansion strategy to Australia. Following the client's approval, I launched and optimized a new Meta Ads campaign that successfully scaled to **148 purchases** while achieving an **average ROAS of 42x**, demonstrating the impact of data-driven market selection and continuous campaign optimization.

PROJECT SNAPSHOT

Industry	Bicycle & Cycling – eCommerce
Platform	Meta Ads (Facebook & Instagram)
Markets Tested	New Zealand → Australia
Campaign Objective	Validate demand, then scale purchases efficiently

THE OBJECTIVE

GROW INTO A NEW MARKET WITHOUT GUESSING

The goal was simple to state, harder to do: prove there's real demand before spending big, make sure the tracking behind that proof can be trusted, and end up with a system that keeps working, not just a single lucky campaign.

THE BUSINESS CHALLENGE

New Zealand was the client's first step outside its home market, and that came with the usual first-time problems:

No past data to say what a "good" cost per sale should look like

No campaign history to learn from on day one

No certainty that purchase tracking was even accurate

A real risk of trusting one early result too much, good or bad

No clear picture yet of which market or message would work best

PROJECT OBJECTIVES

Prove there was real demand in New Zealand before spending more

Make sure tracking was accurate, so every later decision could be trusted

Look beyond the live campaign for stronger opportunities elsewhere

Move budget to a better market if the data showed one

Build a system that keeps improving, not a one-time win

24

2

1

Campaigns

Account ID: 65300499...

Opportunity score: 89

Updated just now

Discard Drafts

Review and publish (12)

All ads

Value reporting

Actions

Had delivery

Active ads

See more

Create a view

Search to filter by: name, ID or metrics

Campaigns

1 selected

Ad sets for 1 Campaign

Ads for 1 Campaign

Maximum: 31 Dec 2022 - 31 Jan 2026

Create

Duplicate

Edit

A/B test

More

Columns: Custom

Breakdown

Off... ↑↓	Campaign ↑↓	Delivery ↑	Results ↑↓	Reach ↑↓	Cost per result ↑↓	Results ROAS ↑↓	Results value ↑↓	Adds to cart ↑↓	Budget ↑↓	Amount spent ↑↓
☒	Explorer Bike campaign - Australia	Active	Website purchases144	55,121	\$33.98 Per purchase	58.28 Value, purchase	\$285,188.00 Value, purchase	1,292	\$120.00 Daily average	\$4,893.05
☐	New Year Update Campaign	In draft	—	—	—	—	—	—	\$40.00 Daily average	—
☐	Explorer Bike campaign - New Zealand	Active	Website purchases4	38,173	\$481.78 Per purchase	4.09 Value, purchase	\$7,889.87 Value, purchase	154	\$40.00 Daily average	\$1,927.13
☐	Blade offer Campaign	Off	Website purchases3	7,381	\$94.18 Per purchase	22.39 Value, purchase	\$6,325.00 Value, purchase	43	\$100.00 Daily average	\$282.54
☐	For Australia Black-Friday Sales Campaign - ...	Off	Website purchases42	10,440	\$24.25 Per purchase	81.40 Value, purchase	\$82,909.01 Value, purchase	194	\$120.00 Daily average	\$1,018.57
☐	For New Zealand Black-Friday Sales Campaign	Off	Website purchases6	17,294	\$93.94 Per purchase	20.10 Value, purchase	\$11,326.70 Value, purchase	20	\$60.00 Daily average	\$563.62
☐	For Australia Black-Friday Sales Campaign	Off	Website purchases30	5,487	\$14.38 Per purchase	157.34 Value, purchase	\$67,865.50 Value, purchase	134	\$30.00 Daily average	\$431.34
☐	Coogee Bikes Awareness campaign	Off	Reach37,640	37,640	\$2.76 Per 1,000 people reac...	— Value, purchase	— Value, purchase	1	\$10.00 Daily average	\$103.90
☐	MM MOF	Off	Website purchases2	599	\$39.22 Per purchase	27.41 Value, purchase	\$2,150.00 Value, purchase	35	Using ad set bu...	\$78.44
☐	New Traffic Campaign - Josh Reel 1	Off	Landing page views740	14,665	\$0.27 Per landing page view	— Value, purchase	— Value, purchase	4	\$200.00 Lifetime	\$199.89
Results from 10 campaigns										

RESEARCH & STRATEGY

EVIDENCE FIRST, SPENDING SECOND

Before any money went toward reach or frequency, three things got checked: buying behavior in New Zealand, what competitors were doing with their ads and offers, and whether the Meta Pixel and Conversion API were tracking purchases correctly. That last check mattered most — every decision after this point would only be as good as that data.

The New Zealand launch was built as a test, not a full-scale push. Its only job was to answer three questions: is there demand, is the audience right, and what does a sale actually cost?

RESEARCH → TRACKING VALIDATION → MARKET TEST → ACCOUNT AUDIT → REALLOCATION

CAMPAIGN APPROACH: FOUR PHASES

FROM A GOOD RESULT TO A BETTER DECISION

Instead of launching and scaling in one motion, the campaign moved through four steps. Each one only happened once the last one proved itself.

Phase 1 – Test New Zealand

The first campaign had one job: find out if there was real demand. It ran small on purpose, just big enough to get a clear answer – and the answer was yes, it turned a profit.

4 purchases from 38,173 people reached

154 adds to cart – a real sign of interest

4.09× ROAS at \$481.78 per sale

Phase 2 – Question the Win

Most accounts would just pour more money into a campaign already returning 4.09×. Instead, that result triggered a bigger question: was New Zealand actually the best place to spend the next dollar, or just the first place tested?

Phase 3 – Look Wider, Then Move Budget

Looking beyond the live test - at the account's full history and audience behavior - pointed to Australia as a much stronger opportunity. Budget followed that evidence. A fresh campaign was built for Australia: a clean account structure, bidding set to favor purchases, and audiences narrowed to people likely to buy.

Phase 4 – Scale With Discipline

Once Australia was live, growth came from testing, not just spending more. New creative was tested daily, budget moved toward what worked, and audiences kept getting refined – which is what kept results climbing instead of flattening out.

144 purchases from 55,121 people reached

1,292 adds to cart, closing at 11.15%

58.28× ROAS at \$33.98 per sale

MARKET-BY-MARKET

SAME PRODUCT. VERY DIFFERENT RESULTS.

Same brand, same bikes, same prices in both countries. The difference showed up after people clicked the ad – in whether they actually finished buying.

Metric	New Zealand (Test Route)	Australia (Scale Route)
Purchases	4	144
Reach	38,173	55,121
Adds to Cart	154	1,292
Spend	\$1,927.13	\$4,893.05
Revenue	\$7,889.87	\$285,188.00
Cost per Purchase	\$481.78	\$33.98
ROAS	4.09x	58.28x

New Zealand shoppers were interested - 154 people added a bike to their cart out of 38,173 reached. But only 4 of those carts turned into a sale. Australia closed carts four times as often, and turned a person reached into a customer about **25×** more often. That's not a sign the ads reached the wrong people. It points to friction somewhere after the click – most likely at checkout, or in trust around shipping and logistics.

BUSINESS IMPACT

WHAT MOVING THE BUDGET ACTUALLY DELIVERED

Cost per sale dropped from \$481.78 to \$33.98 — about 14× cheaper

ROAS grew from 4.09× to 58.28× in the new market

Sales jumped from 4 to 144 without spending 14× more to get there

A good result was treated as a question, not a finished job

Every decision was backed by tracking that had already been checked and trusted

The account became a system that keeps improving, not a one-off campaign

KEY TAKEAWAYS

WHAT THIS PROJECT REINFORCED

Profitability doesn't always justify scaling: A positive ROAS should be evaluated alongside long-term growth potential.

Accurate tracking drives better decisions: Reliable conversion data is the foundation of optimization.

Analyze the entire account, not just one campaign: Historical data can reveal stronger market opportunities.

Funnel metrics uncover optimization opportunities: Add-to-Cart data helped identify where customers dropped off.

Choose the right market before increasing budget: Shifting to Australia delivered significantly better results than scaling New Zealand.

Scaling requires continuous optimization: Ongoing testing, audience refinement, and budget adjustments sustained campaign growth.

CONCLUSION

TESTING CAREFULLY FOUND A MARKET THAT GUESSING NEVER WOULD HAVE

This project shows what happens when you treat a good result as a question, not an answer. By checking the tracking first, testing New Zealand on purpose rather than by default, and reviewing the whole account before moving budget, the campaign found a market that cost 14× less per sale — and built something in Australia that keeps getting better, not just a campaign that got lucky once.